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1. State Formation, Capitals & Union Territories

- Goa India ka 25th state bana 30 May 1987 ko — pehle (19 Dec 1961 se) Goa, Daman aur Diu Union Territory tha; 56th Constitutional Amendment Act 1987 ke tahat alag state ka status mila. [Q567]
- Maharashtra aur Gujarat states 1960 mein banaye gaye. Other states ki formation: Andhra Pradesh (1953), Arunachal Pradesh (1987), Assam (1950), Bihar (1950), Chhattisgarh (2000), Haryana (1966), Himachal Pradesh (1971), Jharkhand (2000), Karnataka (1956), Kerala (1956), Madhya Pradesh (1950), Manipur (1972), Meghalaya (1972), Mizoram (1987), Nagaland (1963), Odisha (1950), Punjab (1947), Rajasthan (1949), Sikkim (1975), Tamil Nadu (1956), Telangana (2014, 29th aur sabse youngest state), Tripura (1972), Uttar Pradesh (1950), Uttarakhand (2000), West Bengal (1950). [Q574]
- Arunachal Pradesh 1972 tak North East Frontier Agency (NEFA) ke naam se jaana jaata tha — 1951 mein Balipara Frontier Tract, Tirap Frontier Tract, Abor Hills District aur Mishmi Hills District ko merge karke bana; 1972 mein rename hokar Union Territory bana, capital Itanagar hai; state ban 20 February 1987 ko. [Q578]
- Dadra aur Nagar Haveli ki capital Silvassa hai. Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu — 26 January 2020 ko naya Union Territory bana (capital Daman); present mein India mein 28 states aur 8 Union Territories hain; erstwhile Jammu & Kashmir state ko 2 UTs (J&K aur Ladakh) mein bifurcate kiya gaya. [Q601]

2. State Symbols — Trees, Flowers, Animals, Birds & Sports

- Hollong (Dipterocarpus macrocarpus) — Assam ka state tree aur tallest tree; upper Assam aur Arunachal Pradesh ke jungles mein 45m tak grow hota hai; Moran community (Assam) ke liye sacred tree hai. [Q562]
- Great Indian Bustard — Rajasthan ka state bird, Desert National Park (Jaisalmer) mein paaya jaata hai; Wildlife Protection Act 1972 ke tahat protected. Other state birds: Uttar Pradesh — Sarus Crane; Sikkim — Blood Pheasant; Bihar — House Sparrow; Andaman Nicobar — Wood Pigeon (official bird). [Q564]
- Brahma Kamal — Uttarakhand ka state flower. Other state flowers: Tripura — Nag Kesar; Himachal Pradesh — Pink Rhododendron; Sikkim — Noble Orchid; Bihar — Kachnar; Uttar Pradesh — Palash; Rajasthan — Rohida. National Flower of India — Lotus. [Q565]
- Giant Squirrel — Maharashtra ka state animal. Other state animals: Goa — Gaur; Haryana — Blackbuck; Himachal Pradesh — Snow Leopard; Madhya Pradesh — Swamp Deer (Barasingha); Sikkim — Red Panda; Kerala — Indian Elephant; Manipur — Sangai deer (endemic, sirf Keibul-Lamjao National Park, Loktak Lake mein paaya jaata hai). [Q571, Q583]
- Mallakhamb — Madhya Pradesh ne 2013 mein apna state sport declare kiya; "Malla" = wrestler, "Khamb" = pole se derive hua. Other traditional Indian games: Gilli Danda (Gujarat), Kho Kho aur Kabaddi (Tamil Nadu), Dhopkel

(Assam), Kokla Chapaki (Punjab), Kambala (Karnataka), Jallikattu (Tamil Nadu). [Q577]

3. City Nicknames

- Kolkata — 'The City of Palaces' (British Raj ke time bani buildings ki wajah se). Jaipur = Pink City (1876 mein Prince Albert ke swagat ke liye pink paint kiya gaya). Lucknow = City of Nawabs (Golden City of the East, Shiraz-i-Hind, Constantinople of India bhi kehte hain). [Q573]
- Hyderabad — 'City of Pearls' (Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah ne found kiya). Other city nicknames: Pune — Queen of Deccan/Oxford of East; Bengaluru — Silicon Valley of India; Chennai — Detroit of Asia; Jamshedpur — Pittsburgh of India; Ahmedabad — Manchester of India; Ajmer — Khwaja ki Nagri; Nagpur — Orange City; Mysore — Sandalwood City. [Q575, Q582]
- Pampore — Kashmir ka "Saffron Town" — GI tag mila Kashmir ke saffron ko. Other nicknames: Pink City — Jaipur; Diamond City — Surat; Leather City — Kanpur; Orange City — Nagpur. [Q580]
- Udaipur — 'Venice of the East' aur 'City of Lakes' (Fateh Sagar, Rang Sagar, Pichola, Swaroop Sagar, Dudh Talai lakes) — Maharana Udai Singh ne 1559 mein found kiya. Jodhpur — 'Blue City' (blue-painted houses old town area mein), Rao Jodha ne found kiya. Jaipur — Pink City; Ahmedabad — Manchester of India; Surat — Diamond City of India. [Q588, Q604]
- Sikkim ko actual inhabitants (Lepchas) apni bhasha mein 'Nye-Mal-Ale' (Heaven) kehte hain — Nepalese ise Sukhim/New Home, Tibetans Denzong/Valley of Rice kehte hain. [Q590]

4. Museums, Monuments, Forts & Heritage Sites

- Gol Gumbaz — Karnataka mein sthit; duniya ka 2nd largest dome; Muhammed Adil Shah (Bijapur ke 7th ruler) ka mausoleum, architect Yaqut of Dabul ne 1656 mein banaya. Other Karnataka heritage: Hampi (UNESCO site), Bidar Fort, Chennakesava Swamy Temple, Mysore Palace. [Q591]
- Jawahar Kala Kendra — Rajasthan (Jaipur) mein, 9 planets ke theme par based, architect Charles Correa ne design kiya — Vastu Purusha Mandala principle follow karta hai. [Q570]
- Indira Gandhi Memorial Tulip Garden — Srinagar mein, Asia ka sabse bada tulip garden, Zabarwan Range ki foothills mein Dal Lake ke paas. [Q572]
- Orchha heritage town — Madhya Pradesh mein, river Betwa ke kinare, King Rudra Pratap Singh ne 16th century mein banaya; UNESCO tentative list mein hai. MP ke UNESCO sites: Khajuraho (1986), Sanchi Stupa (1989), Bhimbetka Rock Shelters (2003), Bhedaghat aur Satpura Tiger Reserve (2021). [Q586]
- Mrignayani ka Mahal — Gwalior mein, Maharaja Man Singh Tomar ne apni Gujar queen Mrignayani ke liye banaya — love ka monument mana jaata hai. Other historical monuments: Hawa Mahal (Jaipur), Lake Palace (Udaipur), Khajuraho Temples (MP), Samode Palace (Jaipur). [Q594]
- Janjira Fort — Maharashtra mein hai (Madhya Pradesh mein NAHI). Other forts: Red Fort (Delhi), Agra Fort (UP), Jaisalmer/Mehrangarh/Amber/Chittorgarh Forts (Rajasthan), Golconda Fort (Telangana), Kangra Fort (Himachal Pradesh). [Q596]
- Napier Museum — Kerala (Thiruvananthapuram) mein, 1855 mein establish, architect Robert Chisholm. Other Kerala museums: Museum of Kerala History, Hill Palace Museum, Indo-Portuguese Museum. Other states: Albert Hall Museum (Jaipur), Salar Jung Museum (Hyderabad), Dakshinachitra (Tamil Nadu). [Q597]
- Namdroling Monastery — Karnataka mein, Tibetan Buddhism ke Nyingma lineage ka duniya ka sabse bada teaching center, 1963 mein Penor Rinpoche ne found kiya. Other monasteries: Tawang (Arunachal Pradesh), Tabo (Himachal Pradesh), Rumtek (Sikkim), Hemis (Ladakh). [Q598]
- India ka ekmatra Naval Aviation Museum — Goa mein, 12 October 1998 ko founded. [Q599]
- Karla Caves — Maharashtra (Lonavala ke paas) mein preserved Buddhist rock-cut caves, Satavahana rule (2nd-5th century BC) ke dauraan banaye gaye, sabse purani cave 160 BC ki hai. [Q600]
- Jantar Mantar — Jaipur ke founder Maharaja Sawai Jai Singh II ne 5 jagah banaye: New Delhi, Jaipur, Ujjain, Mathura, Varanasi — Nagpur mein Jantar Mantar NAHI hai. [Q589]

- Vivekananda Rock Memorial — Kanyakumari mein, 1970 mein banaya gaya, Laccadive Sea (Lakshadweep Sea) se ghira hai — yahan Swami Vivekananda ne 3 din meditate kiya tha. [Q602]
- Wing style architecture — West Bengal se related. Temple architecture styles: Nagara style (Himalayas-Vindhyas region, e.g. Kandariya Mahadev Temple MP, Konark Sun Temple); Dravida style (gopuram entrance, e.g. Kanchipuram/Thanjavur/Madurai temple towns); Vesara style (Nagara-Dravida mix). [Q607]
- Ranikhet hill station — Uttarakhand ke Kumaun region mein. Other hill stations: Uttarakhand (Mussoorie, Nainital, Dhanaulti, Chakrata); Himachal Pradesh (Shimla, Manali, Mashobra, McLeodganj, Dharamshala, Dalhousie); Sikkim (Gangtok, Aritar); Kerala (Munnar, Ponmudi). [Q566]

5. Institutes, Universities & Libraries

- Tamil University — Thanjavur (Tamil Nadu) mein, 1981 mein establish, founder M.G. Ramachandran (poorv CM) — Tamil bhasha mein higher research ke liye. Tamil Nadu: capital Chennai, Legislative Assembly 234 seats, Lok Sabha 39, Rajya Sabha 18, High Court Madras. [Q563]
- Central AGMARK Laboratory — Nagpur mein sthit; AGMARK agricultural products ki quality assure karne wala certification mark hai; 11 regional AGMARK labs bhi hain (Delhi, Kolkata, Mumbai, Jaipur, Amritsar, Kochi, Kanpur, Guntur, Chennai, Bhopal, Rajkot). [Q579]
- Institute of Road Traffic Education (IRTE) — Faridabad mein sthit, 1991 se research-based not-for-profit organization, road safety management ke liye kaam karti hai. [Q592]
- Central Institute of Indian Language (CIIL) — Karnataka (Mysore) mein, 17 July 1969 ko founded, Indian languages ke development ko coordinate karta hai — 5 Regional Language Centers bhi hain. [Q593]
- National Library of India — Kolkata (Belvedere Estate, Alipore) mein, 1836 mein Calcutta Public Library ke roop mein sthapit, 1948 Act se National Library bana; Maulana Abul Kalam Azad ne 1 Feb 1953 ko public ke liye khola. [Q595]
- Banaras Hindu University (BHU) — Uttar Pradesh (Varanasi) mein, Pandit Madan Mohan Malviya ne 1916 mein found kiya. Other universities: Nalanda University (Bihar, 427 AD), Aligarh Muslim University (UP, 1877), University of Calcutta (WB, 1857), Allahabad University (UP, 1887). [Q605]

6. Culture, Dance, Art & Festivals

- Khamba-Thoibi — Manipur ke Moirang kingdom ka classical epic-based folk dance, Meitei language mein Khamba-Thoibi ki love story par based. Manipur ke other dances: Manipuri, Nupa, Pung Cholam, Dhol Cholam, Manipuri Raas Leela. [Q569]
- Kochi-Muziris Biennale (Kerala) — Contemporary art ki exhibition, desh ki sabse badi art exhibition aur Asia ka sabse bada contemporary art festival, 12 December 2012 ko shuru hua. [Q610]

7. Infrastructure — Bridges, Tunnels, Airports & Transport

- Chennai Mofussil Bus Terminus — Asia ka sabse bada bus terminus, Koyambedu mein 37 acres mein phaila hai. World ka sabse bada bus depot — Millennium Park Bus Depot (Delhi); world ka sabse bada bus station — Preston Bus Station (UK). [Q576]
- Jalandhar (Punjab) — garrison town (cantonment town) hai — British period mein military support ke liye establish. Other garrison towns: Ambala (Haryana), Mhow (MP), Babina (UP), Ramgarh (Jharkhand). [Q587]
- Byorong Bridge — Arunachal Pradesh mein, river Siang par, India ka sabse lamba (300m) single-lane steel cable suspension bridge, DoNER Ministry ke funding se bana. Other bridges: Assam (Bogibeel, Bhupen Hazarika Setu), Manipur (Imphal River Bridge), Mizoram (Chite Bridge). [Q584]
- Pir Panjal (Banihal) Railway Tunnel — Jammu & Kashmir mein, 11.2 km lambi, India ki ekmatra broad gauge mountain railway tunnel, Quazigund-Baramulla ke beech. Other J&K tunnels: Shyama Prasad Mukherjee Tunnel

(9km), Nandni Tunnels (1.4km), Jawahar Tunnel (2.85km). [Q608]

- Gujarat — India ka sabse zyada airports wala state (Ahmedabad, Vadodara, Bhavnagar, Bhuj, Gandhidham, Mundra, Porbandar, Surat, Keshod). International airports mein Kerala top par hai (4 airports: Kannur, Cochin, Thiruvananthapuram, Calicut). [Q609]

8. Food & Culinary Specialties

- Nagpur — oranges ke liye famous. Other fruit cities/states: Apple bowl of India — Kotgarh (Himachal Pradesh); Grapes — Nasik (Maharashtra); Litchi — Muzaffarpur (Bihar); Pomegranate — Solapur; Strawberry — Mahabaleshwar; Alphonso Mangoes — Ratnagiri; Bananas — Jalgaon; Guavas — Allahabad; Anjeer — Pune; Papaya — Anantapur; Plum — Himachal Pradesh. [Q568]
- Chainsoo — Uttarakhand (Garhwal region) ki famous dal (Urad/Kali Dal) preparation. Other famous foods: Uttarakhand (Kumaoni Raita, Gahat ki Dal, Kafuli, Aloo ke Gutke, Baadi); Arunachal Pradesh (Pika Pila, Lukter, Pehak); Maharashtra (Bhaji, Vada Pav, Misal Pav); Telangana (Sarva Pindi, Sakinalu). [Q603]
- Khandvi — Gujarat ki delicacy (gram flour + yogurt). Gujarat ki other delicacies: Dhokla, Thepla, Undhiyu, Aam Shrikhand. Other states: Maharashtra (Vada Pav, Puran Poli, Modak); Karnataka (Masala Dosa, Mysore Pak, Korri Gassi); Odisha (Mudhi Mansa, Kora Khai, Palua Ladu). [Q606]

9. Wildlife & Natural Resources

- Hydrotherapy treatment centre for elephants — Mathura mein (UP Forest Department + Wildlife SOS collaboration), arthritis/joint pain/foot ailment ke liye high-pressure water jets se treatment. Project Elephant 1992 mein launched hua; National Elephant Day = 13 March, World Elephant Day = 12 August. Elephant reserves: Mayur Jharna (WB), Singhbhum (Jharkhand), Mayurbhanj (Odisha), Terai (UP). [Q581]
- Arunachal Pradesh — India ka highest graphite reserve wala state (GSI 2019 report ke anusaar ~35% total reserve), uske baad J&K, Odisha, Jharkhand, Tamil Nadu. Graphite ek-matra non-metal hai jo electricity ka good conductor hai. GSI 1851 mein set up hua tha, HQ Kolkata. [Q585]

10. ⚠ Traps / Key Differences Summary

- ⚠ Trap: Jantar Mantar Nagpur mein NAHI hai — 5 jagah hai: New Delhi, Jaipur, Ujjain, Mathura, Varanasi. [Q589]
- ⚠ Trap: Janjira Fort Maharashtra mein hai, Madhya Pradesh mein NAHI. [Q596]
- ⚠ Trap: Quicklime/Nicknames confuse mat karna — Jaipur = Pink City; Jodhpur = Blue City; Udaipur = Venice of East/City of Lakes; Hyderabad = City of Pearls; Kolkata = City of Palaces; Chennai = Detroit of Asia. [Q573, Q575, Q582, Q588, Q604]
- ⚠ Trap: Sangai deer sirf Manipur mein paaya jaata hai (Keibul-Lamjao National Park) — India ka koi aur state nahi. [Q583]
- ⚠ Trap: Arunachal Pradesh 1972 tak North East Frontier Agency (NEFA) kehlata tha — Meghalaya/Nagaland/Mizoram alag naamon se nahi jaane jaate the. [Q578]
- ⚠ Trap: Gujarat = sabse zyada total airports; Kerala = sabse zyada international airports — dono alag records hain. [Q609]